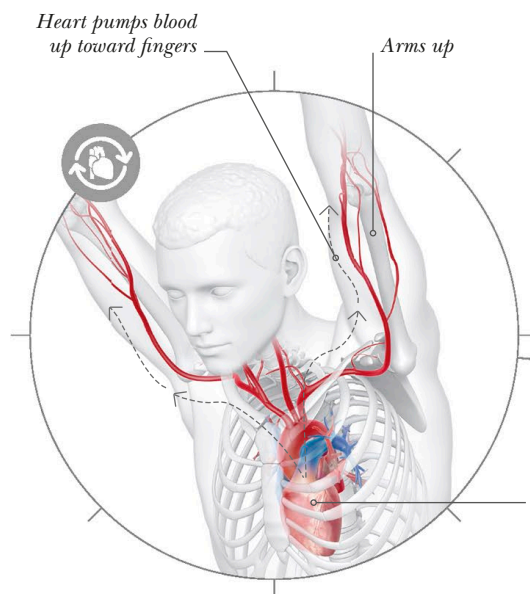
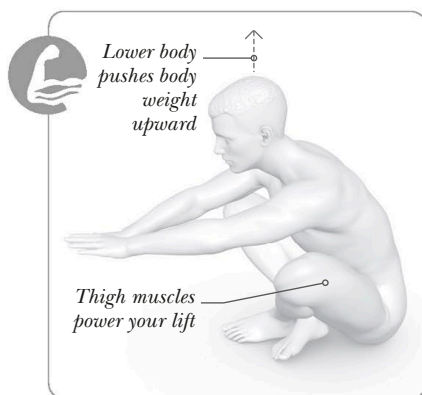


» **CLOSER LOOK**

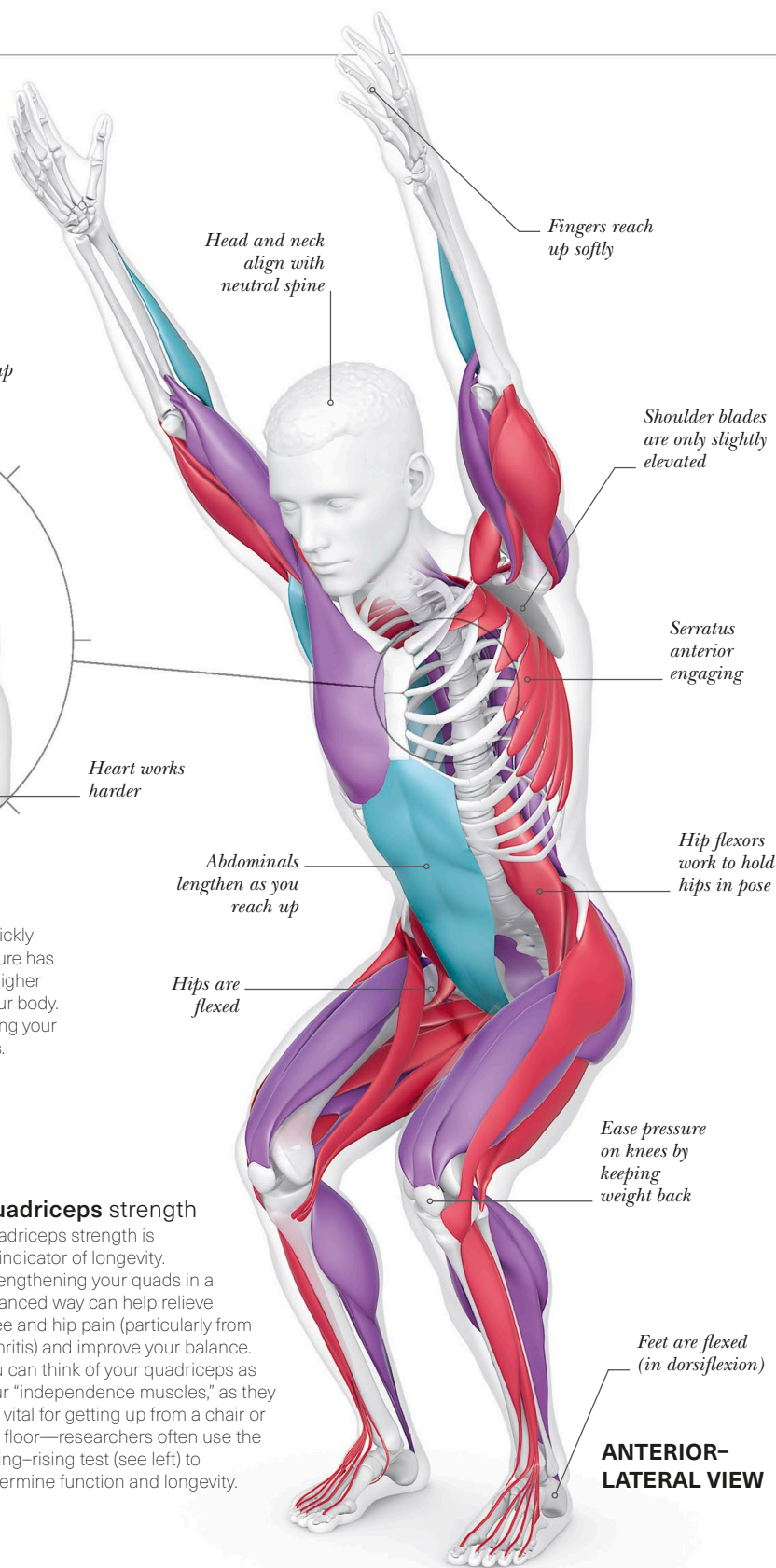
Chair pose leads to body-wide effects. Lifting your arms, for example, raises blood pressure as well as increases the lumbar load, which tests your cardiovascular system and core muscles.

**Blood pressure**

Raising your arms overhead in any pose quickly increases your heart rate because blood pressure has to increase to pump all the way to your now-higher fingertips. Be conscious of these changes in your body. If you have high blood pressure, consider keeping your arms down with your hands on your hips.

**Quadriceps strength**

Quadriceps strength is an indicator of longevity. Strengthening your quads in a balanced way can help relieve knee and hip pain (particularly from arthritis) and improve your balance. You can think of your quadriceps as your "independence muscles," as they are vital for getting up from a chair or the floor—researchers often use the sitting–rising test (see left) to determine function and longevity.

**ANTERIOR-LATERAL VIEW**